



A wireless PCMCIA card for a laptop. These are credit-card sized devices

The term ‘Wireless Home Networking’ is something that has just begun to make sense. Until a few years ago, wireless networking was something that brought to mind a swanky corporate office with money to splurge on ‘extras’ such as wireless technologies. Today, wireless devices and peripherals are universal, and don’t cost an arm and a leg. Most laptop owners already have wireless-capable hardware; all PDAs and cell phones available today are either wireless-enabled or wireless-capable. Using such devices, one can easily set up a Local Area Network (LAN), or a PAN at home.

Before we get into how you can identify the solution you need (Chapter 2), or how to go about installing it (Chapter 3), you should know what technologies and protocols are available, and how they work.